

tion level at the points of interconnection, where the mobile traffic is exchanged between networks belonging to different operators, leads to call drops and deterioration in voice quality and is the primary reason that drives consumers to repeat calls.

Tata Teleservices Limited (TTSL) has begged the 'least congested network' tag. This is the third consecutive time that the TRAI report on network congestion has rated TTSL as the best amongst all pan-India telecom operators.

BSNL, Airtel launch IPTV

Bharat Sanchar Nigam Ltd (BSNL), in association with Smart Digivision, has launched interactive personalised television and video services for its customers. The transmission of content through Internet protocol television (IPTV) system implies delivery of digital content services to subscribing customers using a broadband Internet connection.

Bharti Airtel too has launched its triple-play service with Airtel digital TV interactive. With this, customers can avail telephony, broadband and entertainment service on a single line.

Airtel's IPTV head-end, with MPEG4-10 compression technology, will offer more content and better-quality images as well as services like live broadcast television, network-based time-shifted TV, video-on-demand and a host of other interactive services. Airtel will deliver its IPTV service to customers through a fibre backbone of carrier ethernet network with last-mile delivery on copper using ADSL2+ technology. The service is available in Delhi, Gurgaon and Noida.

Big TV reaches 500,000-subscriber mark in South

Big TV, a wholly owned subsidiary of Reliance Communications, has reached the figure of 500,000 subscribers in



Pioneer's top executives posing with brand ambassador Shahid Kapoor at the India launch

the four southern states within five months of its launch. This current feat in South, as per the company, follows Big TV DTH's earlier accomplishment of crossing the one-million-subscriber milestone nationally within 100 days of launch in August 2008.

Amongst the southern states, Karnataka with Bangalore topped the list by crossing 150,000-strong customer base on January 1, 2009. This was achieved with a DTH sales network of over 3500 retailers across Karnataka.

Pioneer launches six car stereo systems

Pioneer India Electronics Pvt Ltd (PIEL), a subsidiary of Pioneer Corporation, Japan, has launched car stereo systems customised to the needs of the Indian market. The line-up includes DEH-P7150UB, DEH-P5190UB, DEH-4190SD, DEH-3190UB, DEH-2190UB and DEH-1190MP. Five of the six models come equipped with a protective dust cover.

The company is upbeat on the growth prospects in the Rs 12-billion in-car entertainment market in India. It is targeting original equipment manufacturer and consumer markets

to garner a prominent position in this segment.

"In home electronics business as well, Pioneer will continue its market research to start sales activities according to market demand. By promoting these two major businesses Pioneer aims to increase its brand awareness and expand business in the growing Indian market," said Takashi Yoshida, managing director, PIEL.

Samsung to launch 35 handsets, focus on HD products

Samsung Telecommunications plans to launch 35 new handsets in India in 2009. The company will also try to offer full-length movies and songs with its handsets. These handsets will cost between Rs 5000 and Rs 10,000.

For rural pockets, Samsung will tie up with local cooperatives to push handset sales.

The company is also focusing on high-definition (HD) products and new technologies to drive growth in the market. It is planning to launch a wide portfolio of such products in its audio-visual categories like TV,